Profile of Waste-picker Welfare Foundation

Name of Organisation	Waste-Pickers Welfare Foundation (WWF)
Trust Registration Number	1690
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Registration Authority	Sub Registrar Shahadra , Delhi under Trust Act
Registered Address	B-12A Gali No 2 East Nathu Colony, Shahdara, Delhi-110093
PAN Number	AAATW4653R
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Account Details	A/c. No. 2401248559732610; IFSC Code: AUBL0002485 A/c. Holder Name : Waste Pickers Welfare Foundation Branch : sector 63, Noida , Gautam Budh Nagar UP-201301
Name of Contact Person	Mr.Virender Kumar
Contact Number	+91-9968125328, +919211997720
Email id	Bali.charan@gmail.com
Website	www.wwfngo.org
CSR-1 **E-ANUDAN**	CSR00037186 DL/00027665

Vision & Mission

Formation of an equitable society where children, women, and other marginalized people can live with self-esteem and dignity. Facilitating the assertion of child rights and gender equality, through application of law and human rights as the instrument of social change. Empowerment of marginalized communities through education, awareness generation and capacity building.

A dignified and inclusive environment for all waste workers, with access to basic services, fair livelihoods, and institutional recognition.

Objectives & Goals

- **Organization & Empowerment:** Unite waste workers under a democratic federation for collective action.
- **Advocacy & Rights:** Champion fair wages, social security, occupational identity cards, and access to government schemes.
- **Gender Equality:** Promote gender-sensitive engagement and women's leadership in the waste sector.
- **Skill Development:** Build capacities of community leaders, union members, and mobilizers.
- **Policy Engagement:** Influence government policies through organized campaigns and sustained dialogue.

Key Work Areas

Communities Covered: Ghaziabad, NOIDA (Utter Pradesh) Delhi NCR.

Activities Include:

- Area mapping and household surveys
- Monthly community meetings and leadership trainings
- Legal support, school admissions, and identity documentation
- Exposure visits and gender sensitization workshops
- Providing loans to women through **SHG** Group which works under District Urban Development Agency(DUDA) | District Ghazibad, Government of Uttar Pradesh | India

Introduction

A Wastepickers, or Chiffonnier, was a 19th- and early 20th- century term for someone who made a living by rummaging through refuse in the streets to collect material for salvage. Scraps of cloth and paper could be turned into cardboard, broken glass could be melted down and reused, and even dead cats and dogs could be skinned to make clothes. The Wastepickerss did not recycle the materials themselves; they would simply collect whatever they could find and turn it over to a "master Wastepickers" (usually a former Wastepickers) who would, in turn, sell it—generally by weight—to wealthy investors with the means to convert the materials into something more profitable.

The Wastepickers are the one who collects the rags from the street, trains localities and from various other places from where a general public would wish never to go there forget about the picking of something. Anybody in the whole society either men women or children can be a wastepicker. It is not because they like this profession of collecting the garbages and rags from different places but it is just because of their poor condition, which makes harassed for their survival in life. And for their survival they are required to do some work.

The Waste pickers are faces difficult situations day by day and things get worst when the government machinery itself infringes their fundamental as well as human rights. Also various policy and programs made by the Government does not reach to the needy ones and remains at paper itself or get completed on paper.

Taking into account several problems that are faced by the waste pickers and for the effective disposal of waste or garbages, ***Mr. Bali Charan*** founded Wastepickers Welfare Foundation in the year 2014.

Background of the Organization

This organization came to be with the effort of some social activists and intellectuals concerned about social inequalities and discrimination prevailing in our society. We began with community-level awareness generation about civic rights paying particular attention to children and women. Initially, we were worried to see the small children engaged in work and helping their parents in their occupations. Later on it was realized that lack of education was a big hindrance in their development and responsible for their vulnerable condition. It was also observed that lots of marginalized children are far from education either because their parents never realized the importance of education or the inaccessibility of school. We concentrated first to mobilize the parents to send their children to school and the Right to Compulsory and free education Act 2009 has been used as tool for mainstreaming these children.

We initiated our intervention in Bhowapur waste pickers community where the majority of children were engaged in waste picking with their parents. We started creating awareness about the importance of education among parents for prohibiting and releasing children from the hazardous occupation of waste picking by mainstreaming them in schools. For their enrollment we had to make advocacy efforts at various levels as denial of school admission for lack of documentary proof was a common phenomenon at that time. This was the period of 2010-11 when Right to Free and compulsory education act 2009 just came into existence and there was no awareness about this act neither among government officials nor the community people. Some of the schools are not following the guidelines of RTE Act 2009, to take admission without any documentary proof related to birth and residence proof. The community was made aware about these provisions and Complaints of Violation from their side, were made to higher authorities and commissions like the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) and Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights (DCPCR).

For the physical accessibility of girls we had to advocate for police protection for their safety on the way to and from school. Also, the community was organized and sensitized toward the need of education particularly among girls.

To prohibit these children from this hazardous occupation, we tried to find out the root causes of their exclusion from the education system. Despite physical barriers, there are multiple socio-cultural barriers that keeping them away from school.. Mothers have no safe child care support available when they need to be away from children. There was no ICDS Centre in this community that time.

We did advocacy for anganwadi center, after 5 years in 2017 an Anganwadi centre was established in Bhowapur jhuggi cluster after our rigorous efforts and advocacy. Also in the beginning the community was unserved by ASHA worker and ANM. The majority of the children were not getting an immunization. As a result of our intensive advocacy with CDMO and concerned dispensary ASHA and ANM was appointed for this area.

Current Programmes:

From 2022 onwards we are working on child rights with the support of "Pahal and RLM Trust CSIE Learning Group- with the following objectives:

- To empower the community and ensured community monitoring in the intervention area to ensure the effective functioning of schools
- To ensure quality education to children within the government school system and thereby enhance their learning levels and retention in the schools
- To provide access and quality education opportunities to out-of-school children in the community.

- To take up networking, Liaoning and advocacy efforts for rightful educational entitlements for children.
- Working closely with the adolescent age group and addressing their issues and ensuring education as well as life skills required to live life with dignity and self-respect.

Women Empowerment (from 2013)

Innovative and unique in many ways this programme ensures cost-effective, hassle-free and speedy delivery of justice, almost at the doorstep of women in distress. From the beginning more than 2000 women in distress has been supported till the date through providing them family counselling and facilitating the legal aids from DLSA and other judicial bodies through C FAR . We have connected 500 women with various pension schemes ie Widow pension, Old age pension and disability pension schemes. Through our regular meetings and one to one interactions capacity buildings of the women's has been done. Women in these communities are so familiar with crisis intervention numbers and they themselves call 181 numbers in every incidence of violence with in their homes or outside it. Currently, we are working for the restoration of the rights of children by ensuring their Education, Health, nutrition and protection. **Also striving for the** empowerment of women through awareness generation and linking them with various social security schemes. We are building their capacities and enabling them to make themselves free from domestic violence. They have also learned to raise voices against domestic violence and inequalities. We are facilitating them to avail the legal aid from DLSA and other judicial bodies. The girls and adolescents of waste picker families we are working with are first-generation learners. Their parents prefer to marry their daughters at early ages, to save them from sexual abuse and harassment in their community and their ways to school and work.

We have enrolled these girls in our Child activity centers and formed groups with girls and adolescents. We interact regularly with these groups and conduct life skill workshops and issue-based discussions with them. Through our intervention, these

girls have understood their rights and learned to raise their voices. They have learned to oppose any kind of harassment and abuse, and report such cases. We also conduct training with children groups which include both girls and boys, where boys are also sensitized about gender discrimination.

These girls of marginalized communities are being connected with sports to break the stereotypes that only boys are able to play games like cricket, hockey, and football. Playing outdoor games is a very exciting and new experience for these adolescent girls. Sometimes they have to struggle with their families to get this permission but they are coming forward.

We are working for girls' education with the objective that no girl from our target area should be out of school so that they can be saved from early marriage and consequent domestic violence. After getting an education these girls will be linked with some skill- building programs so that they can be financially independent. Because without financial security they won't be able to lead a dignified violence-free life.

We also have women groups and built their capacities through various training and workshops. They have also learned to raise voices against domestic violence and inequalities.

Brief History of Waste-Pickers Welfare Foundations (WWF)

Waste-Pickers Welfare Foundations (WWF) is established in 2006 and got formally registered in the year 2014 under TRUST Act in India.

Since the establishment WWF is committed to serve the Waste-Pickers and disposal of the wastes that leads to the clean and healthy environment. It is aimed as an initiative for the better future of by caring for the uncared for, the vulnerable and neglected and needy ones in the manner which is holistic. They go through the process of development which is sustainable and aims at restoring the dignity that rightfully belongs to them. WWF is motivating and partnering with other NGOs and the Governments in uplifting the waste-picker. WWF's relief and development programmes provide a model for involvement in the development process, which is equitable, sustainable, and valuebased.

WWF has worked in the following areas and programs in order to achieve its mission and objectives.

1. Swach Bharat Abhiyan Health Camp
    A. EYE Checkup
    B. General Routine Checkup
2. Education
    A. Schools
    B. Distribution of Books and Bags
3. Awareness
    A. Regarding their Legal Rights

B. Use and Bad Impact of Drugs and Alcohol
C. Livelihood Work

4. Environment
   A. Cleanliness of Environment
   B. Disposal of Waste
   C. Impact of Good Hygiene over health
   D. Plastic Waste Management

5 Distribution of Ration among the Waste pickers

Name of the Project Holder/ Managing Trustee: VIRENDER KUMAR

Background of the Project Holder/

B,tech in Computer science and nearly 3 year's hands-on experience ranging from grass root to planning implementation, Monitoring and coordination on social, rights and educational issues prevailing with women, adolescent and children. Guided by the sense of service and commitment to society. Keen to continue working on these issues.

I have been affiliated with '**wastpicker's welfare foundation** a registered society as Managing Trustee since 2024. Through this organization working on the issue of Gender discrimination and Child rights issue. Prior to that remained affiliated with various women organizations in Delhi.

PAHAL AND RLM Trust CSEI, JANPAHAL, DASAM fellow since 2020, achievement of the period

- Enrollment of all out of school children in school.
- Advocacy for the appointment of ASHA worker was done with CDMO East district after which an ASHA was appointed for Bhowpur jhuggi cluster and later for Gharoli cluster.
- With the appointment of ASHA, immunization of children and pregnant women got initiated. Registration of pregnant women in the Dispensary and hospital started. Presently all children below 6 years are being immunized.
- Anganwadi was established in 2017 in Bhowapur as a result of continuous advocacy efforts.
- Children organized in groups feel more confident and united. Their speaking skills have been improved and hidden qualities could be identified. Through linkages with the Child Federation, they could be exposed to larger platforms.

January 2022 onwards working with the support of Sonalika Learning Group and Pahal Socity for cating the waste picker children through building their learning outcomes and personality development with the help of Child Activity Centre. Prior to that remained affiliated with various women organizations in Delhi.

Proposed Intervention area and Demographic Information

Proposed intervention area covers Gajipur Jhuggi farm area in ward Gharauli ward in east Delhi district and Bhowapur cluster in and Bhapura and Shihani .Teala mod Ghaziabad district in NCR. Most part of our targeted intervention area falls in east Delhi district and located at the periphery of Gazipur landfill at 1-5 km from the site. The garbage mountain is in the middle of these communities dividing it in to two different areas. Bhowapur is also located in the periphery east Delhi .Total population of this whole area is around 1,50000.But our main focus will be on following pockets .

Gajipur Jhugi farm This slum in East Delhi district is located on the periphery of the Ghazipur landfill, around 1 kilometre

away from the site. The total population of the 528 households of Ghazipur dairy farm is 2251, comprising 53 percent male and 47 percent female populations. The total number of children is 1055 which is equal to 47 % of total population of the area.

90 percent of these families have migrated from West Bengal and the rest from Bihar and UP. Most of the children (61 percent) of the area are engaged in rag picking with their parents.

The whole area is in a grip of environmental contamination due to this mountain of garbage. This community provides the service of cleanliness to a major part of Delhi and they themselves live a very unhygienic and unsafe life. Moreover, the life of the children in this occupation is more unsafe. They have to bear many kinds of physical as well as mental tortures. The girls and women are sexually abused and exploited. Education, health, and nutrition of children, and curbing domestic violence against women are our main focus of work in this area.

Gajipur dairy farm comprises the Gajipur jhuggi cluster, the waste picker's community and gajipur dairy farm area, where the main occupation of the households is dairy farming and related work.

ent out of school children were engaged in some kind of child labour, girls mainly in domestic workers and boys mostly in rag picking and factory work.

We initiated with regular NFE classes with 25-30 children regularly to prepare them for admission in appropriate classes. With the In Gajipur, total 31% of the school going age children are out of school. This number is 23% in the 6-14 years of age group. 57% of total out of school children are dropouts, and the remaining 43% are those children who have never been to school.

The out of school number is alarmingly high (62 %) in 14-18 years of age group. In this age group 69% children became dropouts, and 31% children never went to school.

Bhowapur Area

Bhowapur : Bhowapur is located in Gaziabad district in NCR .Total population of our intervention area in Bhowapur in 600 families is 4000 with 1500 children. All these families are engaged in waste picking. Children of these families are far from education and almost 40 percent children are out of school. Bhowapur is the jhuggi cluster near Kaushabi (Gaziabad) loated between bhowapur village and Gazipur Sabji mandi . It contains 250 jhuggis of people migrated from West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar. Most of the male population has been engaged in the factories of Noida and Gaziabad , Ragpicking , construction work and Rickshaw pulling. Women and girls are employed as domestic workers in nearby areas.

This jhuggi cluster is located in the Periphery of Delhi and Ghaziabad and none of the resident was having Residence proof and identity card. Most of the children were being denied for admission in Delhi Govt / MCD Schools and Gaziabad schools without residence proof. Consequently only 5-10 percent children were getting admission in Govt Schools and rest 5-10 percent of the school going children had been studying in nearby unrecognized private schools. Large proportion of remaining 80 perchelp of volunteer Geeta we have already started mainstreaming the children through helping them in their enrollment in schools located in Gazipur and Bhowapur village. Recently 20-25 children attending the classes have been registered in Sarvodaya School Gazipur and Mcd Primary School Gazipur. Rest of the Non School going children are being prepared for the appropriate classes and will be registered in coming years.

WWF has been working in empowering the living style of wastepickers in bhowapur, kaushambi , Ghaziabad and Delhi NCR since 2014 . along with providing health , food, clothing facilities the organisation has been working in education. Because we found there are many kids who are deprived from their schooling. we do survey on daily basis about whether there is any kid who doesn't go to school? If we find any such cases we help them to enroll in school, we help them to complete their basic required documents as adhar card, birth certificate, caste certificate, etc. and we also ensure that they must get their study materials. We also support for their tuition classes so that they can perform better in their academic result.

The organisation is working for providing platform to hidden and underprivileged talented students or people for any age group who are not able to pursue their talent skills as dancing, acting, singing, playing musical instrument, taekwondo, martial art, etc due to money and unreachable platform. The organization is empowering the societies who haveany skills so that they can become self employed or entrepreneur. The organization is always take instant initiative to help when any disaster or pandemic occurs as earthquake, flood orany epidemic disease.

The organization is running Pathshala and coaching center fromnursery to graduation for those underprivileged studentswho are deprived from best quality of education due to high demanded fees charged by other private institution.

The organization is also running apermanent project of Cutting-Tailoring&BeauticianTraining For the womenfolk of the SC/ ST/OBC, Minorities and other Backward Communities who are deprived from human rights and theyare neglected in all sphere of life such as education, health care, economics social, cultural, political and administrative field. They survive amidst gender .

discrimination, exploitation, atrocities and violence. Their representation in nation building activities are for below expected level. If they are not placed in the society with dignity and honour no nation can prosper.

The organization is a registered group and also working for the social-economics development of the weaker section of the people specially for the welfare of the most distressed anddepressed womenof SCs, STs,Minorities and women empowerment.

Occupation Structure

Most of the working population of this area in engaged unorganized sector particularly, street vendors, Rickshaw- Auto drivers Construction workers , Factory labourer and private sector jobs. Besides this population in some clusters like Gazipur dairy farm jhuggi cluster, Gharauli jhuggi, and Bhowapur jhuggi are totally employed as waste pickers .Total 1140 families in these clusters are working as waste pickers. Children in these families are either part time or full time workers in landfill , hence most of them are out of school.

Gharoli area comprises three communities and the occupation of these three clusters is different from each other. The main occupation of Sapera basti is private jobs and construction labour. 51% of all the employed population is engaged jointly in these two occupations. As snake chanting has been banned, the people of Sapera basti had to shift to these occupations. 21 people from this community are still employed in traditional occupation like playing drum and been.

Problem Statement/Areas

Rag picking is probably one of the most dangerous and dehumanizing activity in India. Children engaged in this occupation, collect hazardous waste without using any gloves or masks and, therefore, often get multiple injuries, rashes and skin allergies'and face the risk to come upon hospital wastes as well as ample of plastic and iron items. They suffer from the diseases, such as respiratory problems, worms, anaemia, fever and other problems which include cuts, rashes, dog bites. They are prone to child abuse and the treatment they receive from society is demeaning in nature. A large number of children going to landfill are found to be drug addicted, which they learn from their elders and peer groups. They consume gutka , tambaku and even become addicted to floot inhaling. The children engaged in waste picking are thus deprived of their human right of respectful life and right to education.

A large majority of the child rag pickers are out of school children, despite the presence of schools in their neighbourhood.Even the children, who are registered in school, also drop out immediately due to number of barriers that the children of waste pickers face in enjoying their right to education. Their school attendance is also affected by the lack of basic amenities in the slum: They have to travel along or cross roads with heavy traffic to reach the schools. School-going girls feel insecure while walking to and from school. Consequently most of the adolescent girls are being dropout after 5th class . Also they are engaged in sibling care. As a result 31% of the school going age children in Gajipur,40 percent in Bhowapur and 22% in Gharauli are out of school.

There is only one MCD toilet for whole community, which is facing the problem of water logging and remains crowded. As a result women and children prefer to use open spaces for defecation which is unsafe for children, adolescents and pregnant

women .The families spent their lives with the children, in very unhygienic conditions. Children suffer from various kinds of illness and disease including anemia and under weight. This starts from pre birth stage as maximum women during pregnancies are seen anemic.

Impact of Pandemic

As most of the people living in the slum are daily wage earners or contractual labours hence due to lockdown most of them have lost their jobs and do not have any alternate source of earning.Lack of awareness among the community members about the precautionary measures is making the people more vulnerable to the disease. Adolescent Girls are facing severe challenges in maintaining their menstrual hygiene. Due to economic crisis and school closures they are unable to get sanitary pads as a result of which they are facing health issues related to Menstrual hygiene. Lack of Documents is a major issue for the community to avail the benefits of the schemes of the Govt. which they are entitled to.

Reasons for Working:

In slums like Gajipur and Gharoli where most of the male members of families are found alcoholic and drug addicted (taking Ganja), involved in gambling children are found living in severe conditions of domestic violence. They get beaten with their mothers and always remain scared and alienated. Girls become most affected by their household atmosphere. In most of the cases mothers have to work out of the homes. In these situations girls have to bear whole responsibilities of the household chorus and sibling care. In the families where both the parents are working outside the yielder daughters have to bear all the responsibility of other members. They are easily targeted to leave the school. Moreover they dropout from the school due to unsafe way to school and eve teasing they face in the road. Community itself is not safe for small children due to drug addicted people and gamblers.

Child marriage is still a prevalent phenomenon, as parents perceive that early marriage is the only way to protect the girls from all kind of abuse and elopement. They take their daughters to their native village and fix marriage as the girls get 14-15 years old.

The environment of the community is not safe and these girls are not protected even within community. Number of case of abduction take place each year in this community, most of these remain unregistered. Some of the adolescents become victim of trafficking and abduction after they choose to leave home on their own.

Children are found engaged in illegal sale of alcohol and Ganja in their community .Most of the time they are employed for this purpose. Children are also found involved in tobacco, Gutka consumption, whitener- fluid inhalation.

Majority of the children of these communities are dropping out from the school and started working with their parents. Due to lockdown income of many parents have been ended and children have to support them in their livelihood. We traced 50 such children who became child labor after school closer and will never return to school again.

Most of the children in these slums are first generation learners and nobody is to teach them in their homes. They could not take online classes because of the unavailability of devices and internet connections.

Most of families are living in small single room house, which is also a barrier in continuing their studies.

Unavailability of household toilets in Gazipur Bhowapur and Gharoli cluster is also a major protection issue for the children as either they have to use community toilet or use the open spaces for defecation.

Proposed Intervention:

Mapping of the out of school children

Educate and prepare these children through 4 Informal learning centers. Enrollment of minimum 80 percent out of school children in school.

Personality building and confidence development of children attending our learning centers.

Computer education for the children Community awareness about gender discrimination.

Formation of children and women group.

Capacity Building, leadership development and legal awareness among of women group.

Formation of groups for conflict resolution at community level.

Expected Outcome within three years:

All the out of school children from target area will be mapped.

Out of school children will get access to education and will be prepared for formal schooling. Enrollment of 50 percent out of school children in formal school to attain age appropriate learning levels.

Their school retention will be ensured through continuous mobilization and proper tracking at community level. Child Labour and Child marriage will be prevented through school retention.

Children attending our informal learning centers will gain insights and life skill training.

Empowerment of women through leadership building and legal awareness.

Lesson domestic violence incidence by conflict resolution at community level.